

H5P and Interactive Content Feasibility Note

Project: Building an Editor Academy Moodle Platform (Team 74, OAPA)

Client: Open Access Publishing Association (open-publishing.org)

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Sprint: Sprint 1, Week 1

[Quick note: we still don't have Moodle sandbox access from the client, so this is based on reading through the Moodle and H5P docs online rather than actually testing it myself. Recommendation stays provisional until access is granted and I can confirm the client's actual Moodle version and setup.]

What I looked into

Investigated H5P and other Moodle compatible approaches to knowledge checks and interactive learning that could support the Editor Academy. The goal was to evaluate benefits, limitations and suitability for the academic audience without committing to a final option yet, since that decision is for the MVP stage.

H5P activity types investigated

- 1. The built in way (mod_h5pactivity):** the newer option, part of Moodle core since around version 4.0. Content sits in the Content Bank so it is easy to find and reuse, and it works properly on the Moodle mobile app. Seems like the safer option to recommend long term.
- 2. The older plugin (mod_hvp):** the original way people added H5P before Moodle built it in natively. Pulls content types straight from h5p.org, over 60 content types available. Problem is it only officially supports up to Moodle 4.5, and Moodle forum threads suggest it is unclear if it will get updated for Moodle 5.x. Feels risky to build on long term.
- 3. H5P Question Set (for knowledge checks specifically):** bundles multiple question types (multiple choice, true or false, fill in the blanks, drag the words) into one short quiz with a progress bar and a final score. This is the content type that actually matches a knowledge check use case, separate from bigger interactive video content.

Knowledge check use cases identified

- Quick check at the end of a lesson or module so editors can confirm they actually took in the material

- Low pressure practice quiz before a bigger formal assessment
- Self study tool that editors can retry as many times as they want
- Recommended to keep question sets to around 5 to 15 questions, mix question types, turn on retry, and give feedback for both right and wrong answers

Suitability for the Editor Academy audience

The Editor Academy is aimed at training editors, peer reviewers and authors, so the audience is adult professionals doing structured online learning rather than a traditional classroom. That fits well with H5P's self paced, low stakes checks, editors can work through modules on their own schedule and use knowledge checks to confirm understanding before moving on. Interactive Video with embedded questions every few minutes also fits well for training style walkthroughs of editorial processes. What does not fit well is using H5P for anything that needs to be formally certified or graded, given the scoring and security issues below, so if certification style outcomes for editors are needed later that should go through Moodle's native Quiz activity instead.

Environment dependencies identified

- Need to confirm the client's actual Moodle version once sandbox access is granted, this decides whether mod_h5pactivity is even available or if we are stuck with the older plugin
- mod_h5pactivity needs Moodle 4.0 or newer, older installs would need the mod_hvp plugin instead or an upgrade first
- H5P content libraries need to be downloaded/installed on the server, either from within Moodle or from h5p.org depending on which route is used, so this needs proper server access, not just an editor account
- If we want H5P questions to appear in the Moodle Question bank and count in a real Moodle quiz, that needs an extra import plugin on top of H5P itself, another dependency to track

Benefits and limitations

Benefits: no coding needed to build content, quizzes/games/interactive video all supported, Moodle auto tracks attempts and completion, many content types follow accessibility guidelines which matters given the academic audience.

Limitations / risks: people with some coding knowledge can currently cheat H5P activities and get full marks without knowing the answers, so it should not be

used for anything graded. H5P content runs client side rather than server side, so it is less secure than a native Moodle quiz question. If an H5P question set is embedded directly inside a Moodle quiz activity, the results do not actually count toward the quiz score, so that combination does not work the way you would expect. H5P and Moodle also both have question types with the same name (like Essay or Multiple Choice) that behave differently, easy to mix up when building content later.

My recommendation (provisional)

Use the built-in mod_h5pactivity option over the older mod_hvp plugin for future proofing. Use the H5P Question Set specifically for knowledge checks since it fits the self-paced practice use case well for the editor training audience. Keep all H5P content ungraded and separate from anything that counts toward a formal mark, if certified/graded outcomes are wanted later that should go through Moodle's native Quiz activity, possibly using the H5P to question bank import plugin to reuse content already built. This recommendation stays provisional until we get sandbox access and can confirm the client's actual Moodle version and environment.

Sources I used

Moodle Docs, Interactive Content H5P activity page (docs.moodle.org)

Moodle Docs, H5P content types of format page (docs.moodle.org)

Moodle Plugins Directory listing for mod_hvp (moodle.org/plugins/mod_hvp)

Moodle.org forum, H5P and Moodle question types of visual guide discussion

H5P.org forum, H5P as a quiz question type in Moodle thread

H5P.org official site (h5p.org)